

West Indies vs New Zealand, 2012

New Zealand's uneasy relationship with the Super Over did not begin at Lord's in 2019. It started seven years earlier, quietly and cruelly, in the Caribbean. Its first brush with the format came in the 2012 World T20 against Sri Lanka, a game it lost in the tie-breaker. Four days later, fate circled back, sharper this time, and far less forgiving. This one was a must-win, and for long stretches New Zealand seemed to have it under control. Even Chris Gayle's early thunder could not lift West Indies beyond 139. The chase unfolded smoothly enough to reduce the target to a manageable 27 from four overs, a position that usually belongs to the batting side. Then Sunil Narine intervened, bending the game to his will with two overs that cost five runs and claimed two wickets. Momentum seeped away. Ross Taylor refused to let it die. His 62 dragged New Zealand back from the brink and into a Super Over. He struck again in the tie-breaker, but West Indies hunted down 18 with unsettling ease. New Zealand was out, and a quiet pattern of heartbreak had begun to form.



« Ross Taylor's 62 dragged New Zealand back from the brink and into a Super Over, where West Indies chased 18 with ease.



South Africa vs New Zealand, 2014

This 2014 World T20 contest ultimately came down to Dale Steyn versus New Zealand. Defending 171, South Africa leaned on its premier fast bowler, and Steyn delivered a masterclass under pressure, finishing with four for 14. He set the tone early, conceding just five runs across his first two overs. When the equation tightened to 29 runs needed from the final three overs, Steyn returned and gave away only eight, keeping South Africa in the game. Ross Taylor and Luke Ronchi struck 14 runs off the penultimate over, narrowing the target to seven off the final six balls. Steyn, though, was relentless. He struck off the first delivery of the final over, firing a thunderbolt to remove Ronchi.

After two consecutive dot balls, Nathan McCullum managed to relieve some pressure by dispatching the fourth delivery for a four. But Steyn responded immediately, dismissing McCullum off the fifth ball to swing the balance back South Africa's way. With three runs required off the last delivery, Taylor could only push the ball straight back to the bowler. Steyn completed the run out to seal a dramatic two-run victory in Chattogram. Reflecting on the narrow defeat, New Zealand captain Brendon McCullum admitted, "We probably should have won it easily — you can't take it to the final over against a top bowler like Steyn."

« Dale Steyn set the tone early, conceding just five runs across his first two overs, and then came back in the final over to pick up two wickets and effect a run out.